

A helping hand

Microsoft is helping Google come up with touch support for a feature that lets browsers fetch inputs from touch mice and pens

Cash @ mail

Now you can simply email money to any debit card using Square Cash, an invite only service currently operational only in the US

Security in Top Gear

Kaspersky Lab recently announced its partnership with Ferrari to provide endpoint security for the car manufacturer's internal IT network. On the eve of this announcement we caught up with Nikolay Grebennikov, Chief Technology Officer, Kaspersky Lab, for a talk about the future of IT security.

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What kind of changes have you implemented in Endpoint Security to make life easy for an IT admin manager?

In the new solution, it's the first time we've introduced system management capabilities, like deployment of operating system images to the machines. In this case we introduced automation of PXE server (Preboot Execution Environment) work too. Next we introduced patch management capabilities with the ability to deploy a patch to a limited number of machines. So you can deploy on a small number for 24 hours and see what happens. If all is okay, we can go ahead and deploy on the others. If something's wrong, the administrator can change the sequence and make an exception.

Also we have introduced for the administrator a very flexible way to manage applications. A list of all applications installed or stored on all of the PCs in the organisation can be seen and it's possible to implement license management. Another example is mobile device management. One of the key challenges was to figure out how to deploy mobile applications on the device since the device is not connected to the corporate network right? For this we've introduced QR codes. We send an email with a QR Code and you can just take your iPad or iPhone or any device, scan the QR code and installation on the device will start automatically.

What about the whole Bring Your Own Computer (BYOC) way of working that's catching on now?

We've introduced "network condition control" and ARP spoofing, (it's like ARP based technology but a specific one) and



Nikolay Grebennikov, Chief Technology Officer, Kaspersky Lab

based on this we understand that this is a new device and we have to check the settings so that administrator can define a very flexible policy for it. We've got about twelve or fifteen options and it's not about "Do you have Kaspersky antivirus software installed". It can be many different things including installed patches, including antivirus databases etc. If it's a mobile device we'll check if it's jailbroken or not. If the device is not compliant, it will have access to just the captive portal where it's possible to get updates and have limited privileges and so on.

At the deployment at the Ferrari plant, there was talk of assembly line computers coming under the purview of Kaspersky protection. Are these x86 machines?

Right now, we are talking about Windows 7 machines. You know in our databases we definitely have viruses for other platforms and architectures. We have viruses for Linux, we have viruses for mobile. So, in general, the answer is yes. As for

specifics, the next stage of our preparation is to understand what kind or types solutions we need there. Remember, we follow a motto See, Control, Protect. It's very important to see to understand what's happened with non-windows machines. A good example is "Critical Infrastructure Protection" for which we're looking at SCADA systems. Here the problem is not the virus itself but the ability to send commands to build or seize control. For example to stop an elevator on a specific floor or increase the speed of rotor at a nuclear power station. And in this case we need intrusion detection system, traffic monitor or other such type of technology. This is what we are going to investigate with Ferrari also.

Sometime last year Eugene Kaspersky said that you are working on a specific operating system designed for industrial control systems? Any update on that?

It's true. We're working on our own operating system, to protect industrial infrastructure. It's a long project and currently we are looking for technology partners such as Siemens and others who provide such infrastructure right now. We have two pilot projects right now, mostly in Russia. My estimation is that the solution will be available in four to five years from now. But what we're developing currently is a dedicated solution for Critical Infrastructure Protection based on our Endpoint solution and understanding of the whole system. We are going to protect all three pieces which are PLCs (Programmable logic controllers) themselves, control centers and the connections between PLCs and control center. So five technologies we have in total in this dedicated solution. The first version of this solution will be available till the end of this year or early 2014. 